

The Ephemeris

June 2022

Volume 33 Number 02- The Official Publication of the San Jose Astronomical Association



June 2022 - September 2022 Events

Schedule subject to change due to Covid-19 restrictions.

Please check our website for up to date information.

Board & General Meetings

Saturday 6/18, 7/16, 8/21, 9/18

Board Meetings: 6 -7:30pm

General Meetings: 8-9:30pm

Fix-It Day (2-4pm)

Currently on hold due to COVID-19 Situation

Solar Sunday (2-4pm)

Sunday 6/5, 7/11, 8/2, 9/13

Intro to the Night Sky Class

In-Town Star Party(9-11pm)

Friday 6/17, 7/15, 7/22, 8/19, 9/16

RCDO Starry Nights Star Party

Saturday 6/25, 7/23, 8/20, 9/17

Imaging SIG Mtg

Tuesday 6/21, 7/19, 8/17, 9/21

Astro Imaging Workshops

(at Little Uvas OSP)

Currently on hold due to COVID-19 Situation

Binocular Star Gazing at Coyote Valley OSP

Saturday 6/18, 7/23, 8/20

Please refer to the SJAA Website home page

(www.sjaa.net) and click on any "Upcoming Event" highlighted in Blue. It will take you to the SJ-Astronomy Meetup page (www.meetup.com/SJ-Astronomy/events/) where you can find specific event times, locations, maps and possible cancellation due to weather.

INSIDE THIS ISSUE

Introductions	2
Thank You JVN	3
EAA	5
Astro Photos	7
Pinnacles Star Party	11
Kid Spot	12
Meeting Minutes	13
Club Programs	14
Membership Form	15

Rho Ophiuchi Cloud Complex
Photo by SJAA Member: Steve Sells
March 12, 2022
Location: Oak Ridge, Los Gatos, California.

Welcome to SJAA New Officers and Program Leaders



Introducing Aaron Nair—SJAA Vice-President and Secretary

Watching the Cosmos series by Carl Sagan and later by Neil deGrasse Tyson, I grew up inspired by and interested in astrophysics. Though a software engineer by profession, I yearn to be in a community of astrophysicists. I'm at a point in life where I can rekindle my interest in astronomy and astrophysics and contribute my time and energy to the scientific community in my neighborhood. Growing up I couldn't have dreamt that I would get such an opportunity. I guess, dreams do come true. It gives me immense pleasure to be part of SJAA and be able to contribute to a community of like minded individuals.



Introducing Jon Anderson—SJAA School Star Party

I grew up in the Santa Cruz mountains during the 1960's and became fascinated with astronomy and space science. I ground my first reflector when I was nine. During this time, I watched human beings land on the moon on a grainy black and white TV. As a teenager in the late 1970's, I watched Voyager 2 launch from Cape Canaveral from the media grandstand. These events along with the beautiful sky view from my family home on top of a mountain, drove my interest in observing and contemplating this amazing place we live in. Three years ago, I formed an astronomy club at my kids' school. I believe that introducing the wonders of astronomy to the young can help to inspire them to learn more.



Introducing Rich Jasper—SJAA Donations

Rich was born in San Francisco, and except for a few years in Germany and Arizona (where he fell in love with the night sky) has lived most of his life in the Bay Area. He majored in physics and astronomy at Berkeley, and after retiring from working 40 years in a field that has NOTHING to do with either, he looks forward to going back to watching the universe.



Introducing Joe Fragola—SJAA Starry Nights Star Party

I was a Member of SJAA quite a while ago (going back maybe 20 years?). I've always enjoyed observational astronomy and I used to volunteer at some of the SJAA School Star Parties (SSP) as well as the monthly public observing events at Houge Park. Back in those days I was observing with an Orion XT-10 Dobsonian telescope, which I still own. Eventually, work and family obligations took away free time I could spend pursuing astronomy. Jumping ahead to the present, there were two events that got me back into astronomy and led me to re-join SJAA.

First, in late 2020 I retired from Lockheed-Martin as an Electrical Test Engineering Manager. It was a great job which included working on one of the original Hubble Space Telescope Science Instruments, the Faint Object Spectrograph. With my college degree in astronomy and physics, I consider the years spent working on HST as the highlight of my career.

I re-joined SJAA last June and became focused on sharing my excitement over this new technology, Electronically Assisted Astronomy (EAA). I re-discovered my passion for observational astronomy and I'm enjoying time spent at SJAA Member observing sessions at the darker RCDO OSP and Mendoza Ranch locations. Earlier this year I agreed to take over as Lead of the Starry Nights Program. A big part of SJAA's "mission" is to educate and inspire the next generation of astronomers. I'm excited to be a part of that goal which also allows me to continue to pursue enjoyment of observational astronomy. I look forward to meeting and working with more SJAA Members as we continue to look up and share the beauty of the night sky with others.

Thank You JVN!

Credit: Marianne Damon

Jim Van Nuland, long-time member of SJAA who has served as President, Secretary, Treasurer, Director, and Chair of the School Star Party Program, has just donated his two personal telescopes to us. Rich Gregor and Marianne Damon received them from his son Ray at the family home at 3509 Calico Avenue. Does that address ring a bell with any of you? For years, this was the official mailing address for SJAA business! Yes, Jim and his home were the center of astronomy activity. Did you know that SJAA used to have a Hot Line? It was the Van Nuland home phone number! They subsequently had a second line installed. After retiring from a career at IBM at the age of fifty, Jim devoted his time and efforts to astronomy. He was particularly invested in the School Star Party Program and was fond of saying that he was paid in "Wows".

I met Jim when I started attending SJAA meetings in 2012. There had been a lunar eclipse, and he asked if I had seen it. I said, "Of course, I wouldn't miss one!" The proud, knowing smile he gave me sealed the deal on our continuing astronomy friendship. He told me of the time, as a young boy, that he heard about a predicted meteor storm. He brought the article to his parents, hoping they would agree to him staying up so very late and being outside in the Wisconsin cold. Between the sky being cloudy and the uncertainty over his parent's decision, he was on pins and needles. But, he said, Mother agreed. The sky cleared and he witnessed one of the biggest meteor showers of the time. As he was born in 1936 and this event was most likely the October 1946 Draconid Storm, he was ten years old at the time.

When I joined, JVN and Jack Zeiders seemed to be the longest continuous members. But in 1954 when our association first formed, Jim would have been around eighteen. So, what was he doing all this time? His son Ray recounts how Jim and his siblings hand-set pins at his Dad's bowling alley. This business had failed six times, but Father knew that automatic setters were just about to come out and so he embarked on this new venture. Until that happened, the kids did the legwork! Jim's sister recalls that he much preferred heading over to the print shop, where he took pride in his skill and speed at typesetting with the tiny lead type. He served in the Navy from '54 to '57, then went to Marquette University for Engineering. He went to work for IBM right out of college, and worked for them his entire career. The family—his wife Florence, lovingly nicknamed Fluffy, and their five children, Patrick, Raymond, Tom, Mike and Barbara—moved to San Jose in 1967. The palm tree outside their house was six feet tall. Jim kept a chart of its growth, and when it became too tall to measure easily, he turned it into a math problem using the shadow method. You should see the tree now, it's a neighborhood landmark!

When offering to donate the scopes, Ray said, "These scopes have a story to tell!" Well, then, let's tell some stories!

Barbara relates how the big white Dob was named Gladys. "When the big 8" stood in the backyard all those years, wrapped up in layers protected from the elements, it reminded Mom of Ruth Buzzi's bag lady character from the Laugh-In TV show: Gladys."

Ann Wetzel Deckers wrote, "Uncle Jim's (and family) summer trips to Wisconsin with Gladys in tow are a special memory for me. Looking at the stars with him was always exciting for the Wisconsin nieces/nephews and other family members. Continuing his legacy of star parties for the schools is something he would be so proud of."

Mark Hancock remembers: "Sometime around 2005, maybe 2006, I was working swing shift at San Jose State University. I saw Jim at the university entrance of Martin Luther King library. I started talking to him. One of his friends was there and they both had telescopes. He said he and his friend are having a little competition: Who can find Saturn first? He did! Then a student walked up and started asking questions, and he said, "Take a look". The smile on his face just made their day. Being friends with Pat and Ray (Jim's boys), we hung out a lot. Both their parents were super nice. They raised some good kids. I can't say enough about what a good family. I met Pat when I was 15 working at Hudson gas station. I'm 60 so it's been a couple years."

Kanch, a SJAA member, wrote: "When I moved to the Bay Area to start work after college, I searched for Astronomy clubs. I found SJAA and attended my 1st ITSP (In Town Star Party) in late '97. I met Jim there. Jim had a white Volkswagen van and a newt he built. One day I remember clearly was a day where Jim and I were the only stargazers at the overflow lot at Henry Coe; I think I harassed him a lot with all my questions that day. I drifted out of the hobby and the area for ~15 years and then joined SJAA in 2015. To my surprise, Jim still drove the same white van and had the same newt. He was still the same approachable person he was then. It was like time stood still around him!"

Rob, our SJAA Treasurer, wrote: "One thing to note is that Jim was on the receiving committee of a community award from then councilmember Judy Chirco, of San Jose's District 9. Along with the award, the SJAA was provided a \$1000 grant from the council member's office. See the April 2010 edition of the Ephemeris, page 4, which is complete with pictures of Jim, Councilmember Chirco, and board member Gordon Reade, and the award itself. The award trophy is proudly housed in the library cabinets at Houge Park.

For years, Jim planned and coordinated the Yosemite Star Party with the National Park rangers. Many in our group have lifelong memories (fond or not!) of the arduous setting up for public viewing, and then camping in the amenities-bare sites. But the setting was spectacular! His last trip was in 2016; the next two years were cancelled due to excessive smoke from our California wildfires. Jim also, for decades, supplied the SJAA Activities Calendar for the Ephemeris. When he was no longer on the Board, he would usually arrive in time for the meeting anyway, and was frequently asked to give his input. As I set up, I would always offer him some early refreshments before others started arriving.

Barbara notes: At his care home many of the residents have a little biography and photo posted outside their room, I made sure to include school star parties when I gave the information for his. He loves for me to read it aloud and he gets the biggest smile when I read the part about his many years of educating children.

Jim loves receiving cards! If you wish to send him a note, his address is:

Jim Van Nuland: c/o Empire Ranch Special Care/ 1801 E. Natoma Street/ Folsom, CA 95630

And if you ask him how he is, I'm sure he'll answer, "Finer than Frog's Hair!"



Jim in Hawaiian shirt with Gladys and the 4" talking to a boy, Transit of Venus



Jim at Glacier Point with his 4", wearing the vest his wife made.



The Palm Tree



Jim in a hoodie with a cane at Glacier Point



His son Ray saying goodbye to Gladys

Electronically Assisted Astronomy (EAA) Coming to a Star Party near you!

Credits: Joe Fragola, Kanch and Abishek

Astronomy has come a long way since the days of ancient cultures looking up at the night sky trying to make sense of what they were seeing. Since the invention of the telescope in 1608 by a Dutch lens maker named Hans Lippershey, advances in technology have led to deeper understanding of the Universe. For generations, amateur astronomers relied on star charts and the art of star hopping to track down deep sky objects (DSOs) beyond the limits of naked eye visibility. With time, changes came along that brought improvements to equipment and technology. One recent innovation has been the development of Electronically Assisted Astronomy (EAA). But will change be accepted by “old school” amateur astronomers?

Among the common reactions to change are skepticism and resistance. We are comfortable with the status quo and how things work in the present. With time there is usually acceptance to doing things differently instead of holding on to the notion of “that’s how we’ve always done it before.” One of the greatest achievements of SJAA is its history of public outreach. While I’m not an expert of the history of SJAA, I know that school star parties, as well as star parties for the general public have been an SJAA tradition that go back decades! When incorporated properly, EAA offers an excellent opportunity to inspire a new generation of astronomers. There are always pros and cons to using new technology. In the case of EAA, there are surely more positive reasons to consider its use.

It is imperative to acknowledge the importance of learning the basics of astronomy, and being able to identify constellations and brighter stars in the night sky should be the foundation on which to build a good observational astronomy background. Getting your hands on a pair of binoculars or a small telescope to start touring the nighttime sky is also a great place to start.



(A) 7-minute exposure of the Whirlpool Galaxy (Messier 51) located in the constellation Canes Venatici
(B) Live images on screens on the April 22 Houge Park Star Party

Let’s first take a look at what EAA exactly is, followed by going over its case for use in SJAA public outreach events. EAA is a new hybrid form of astronomy that involves the use of electronic aids to significantly enhance viewing capabilities of the night sky, for the observer in nearly real time. The telescope’s eyepiece is replaced with a camera which captures a series of short exposure images and passes it on to a software program that stacks these images using preset configurations to output visually stunning images of objects in the night sky.

Viewing DSOs fundamentally needs more light into the scope, which directly translates to a larger aperture, however the relatively new alternative - EAA, has the added benefit of additional electronics and night vision enhancement technology, that amplifies the light coming into the telescope’s eyepiece or a CCD/CMOS camera without increasing the aperture of the scope itself. This has indeed allowed the wider amateur astronomer community to observe the night sky with relatively lower aperture scopes in less-than-ideal conditions like on a full moon night or under light polluted skies.

EAA provides an optimal hybrid approach somewhere between the classic real-time night sky observations and long-exposure astrophotography. Instead of viewing objects directly through the eyepiece, it involves a live-viewing on a smartphone or tablet. The longer the observer waits, the more detailed the final image gets. Also, it’s possible to obtain a stunning image of a deep sky object, much faster than long-exposure astrophotography techniques, that involve hours of capture time, followed by an equivalent/more hours of post-processing time.

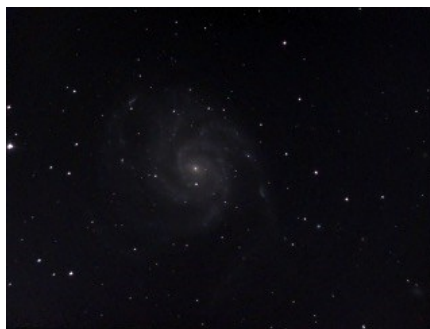
However, it does remain true that traditional long-exposure astrophotography surely can produce much more detailed and rich images of DSOs, than EAA. Although all techniques have their own merits and demerits, just the relative ease of access to setup equipment, ability to generate color images, and the much-shorter time involved in photographing DSOs has caused the community to take interest in Electronically Assisted Astronomy.

So now that we understand what EAA is, let's take a leap forward and look at the case for using EAA at SJAA public outreach events. The first point that should be accepted is that these days, pursuing a hobby in observational astronomy is hampered by light pollution in a city like San Jose. Not being able to see stars fainter than 2nd or 3rd magnitude puts a serious damper on learning how to find a lot of the constellations. The good news is that your hunt for identifying brighter stars won't be impacted too severely. However, the "filter" imposed by light pollution can frustrate efforts to use traditional star hopping to find DSOs. The first EAA solution to the problem of star hopping under light polluted skies is the "Go To" telescope. How wonderful to have the view of the night sky expanded to allow observation of DSOs within the limitations of the telescope optics and sky conditions from your observing site. Will you be able to see every DSO located in your local sky? No, but you'll be locating many more DSOs than would be possible using traditional methods.

The next advantage of EAA is the amount of detail that can be viewed. Images are being collected and viewed on a CMOS-type sensor which is more sensitive than the human eye. This allows more detail to be viewed. If using a color sensor rather than black and white, those grayish smudges visible through traditional telescopes are visible in red, pink, yellow, and green.

Lastly, another benefit of EAA is that it augments teaching and learning about celestial objects beyond what can be done with an eyepiece. A presenter can explain to a group what they are observing while incorporating tools like electronic star charts & internet based information in real time. This is invaluable for events like school star parties.

EAA should be considered a valuable supplement to traditional telescopes at star parties. SJAA has already broken the ice with respect to EAA for public outreach. The In-Town Star Party, held on April 22 at Houge Park was conducted using three Unistellar eVscopes. Two of the telescopes at ITSP used iPads connected to projectors to view live images on screens. The third eVscope is a model that has an electronic eyepiece, so images were viewed both through the eyepiece and directly on an iPad connected to the eVscope's Wi-Fi network. As a result of lessons learned from ITSP, it was decided that future public star parties would not make use of projectors and screens to view live images from these telescopes.



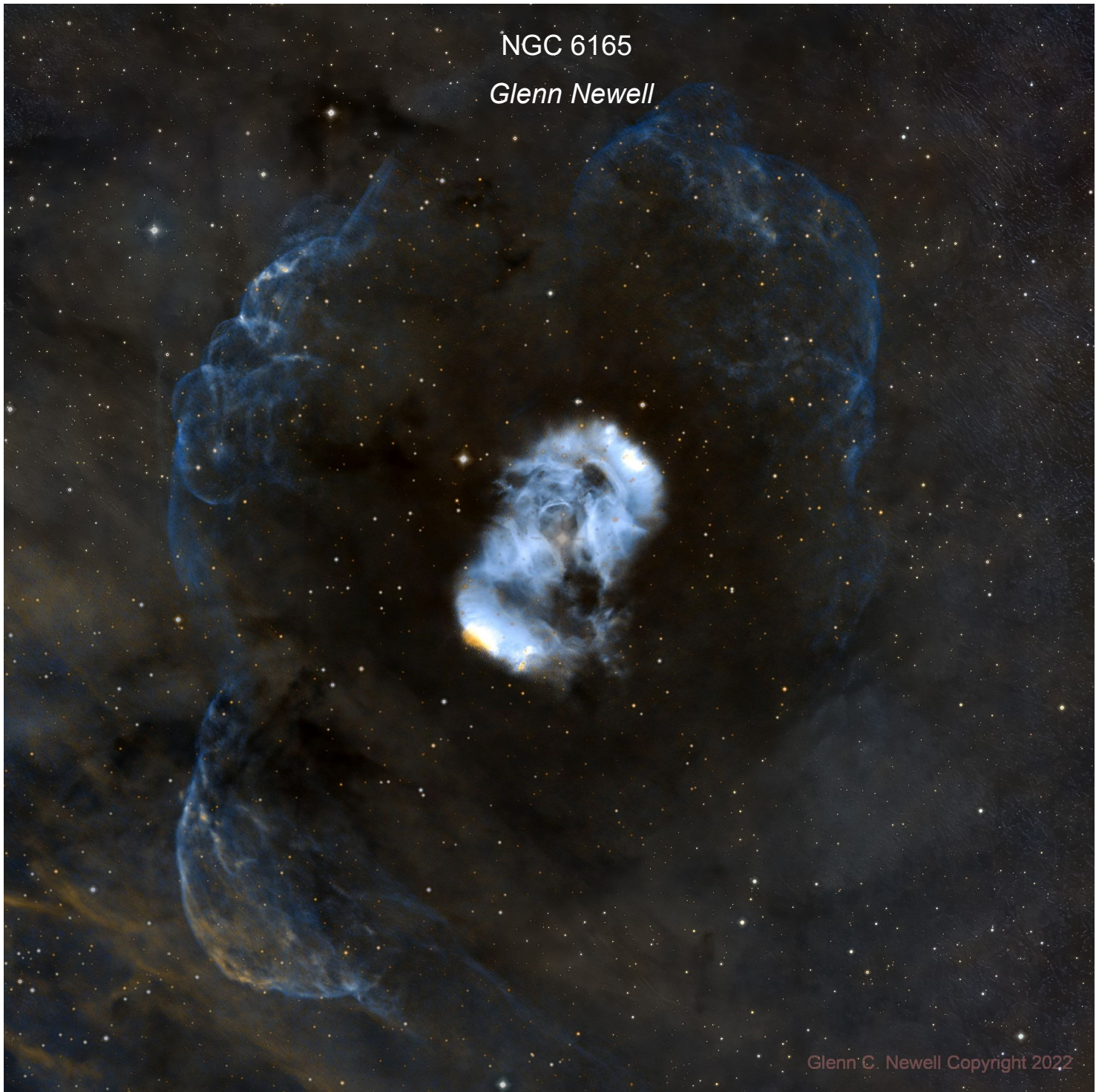
(A) 14-minute exposure of the Sombrero Galaxy (Messier 104) located in the constellation Virgo.
(B) 15-minute exposure of the Pinwheel Galaxy (Messier 101) located in the constellation Ursa Major.

Weather permitting, by the time you are reading this article in the June edition of The Ephemeris, at least two additional SJAA star parties incorporating EAA will have been conducted. The goal is to have at least one eVscope present at such events to offer live views of images on an iPad. In the Fall, we are hoping to incorporate EAA into the School Star Party Program as well.

In addition to a Club-owned eVscope, there are at least four other SJAA Members who have purchased one. In fact, one of the Members made the decision to purchase his eVscope after seeing them in action at the April ITSP. There is also at least one SJAA Member who owns a similar automated imaging telescope, called Stellina.

So, for now, EAA is here to stay. We will continue to incorporate lessons learned from public events in how we use EAA to supplement public astronomy outreach events. Hopefully more SJAA Members will get out to our star parties this summer to see EAA in action. Your comments and suggestions on how to improve the use of EAA are welcome.

A big part of SJAA's "mission" is to educate the public and inspire the next generation of astronomers. We are all passionate about astronomy and love to share our knowledge and enthusiasm with others. Yes, we should continue to practice and respect traditional methods used for observational astronomy. But, as a Club, we should evolve and embrace new technology that contributes to the goal of educating and inspiring. EAA can play an important role in achieving our goal.



Date: July 30 2021 to April 11 2022

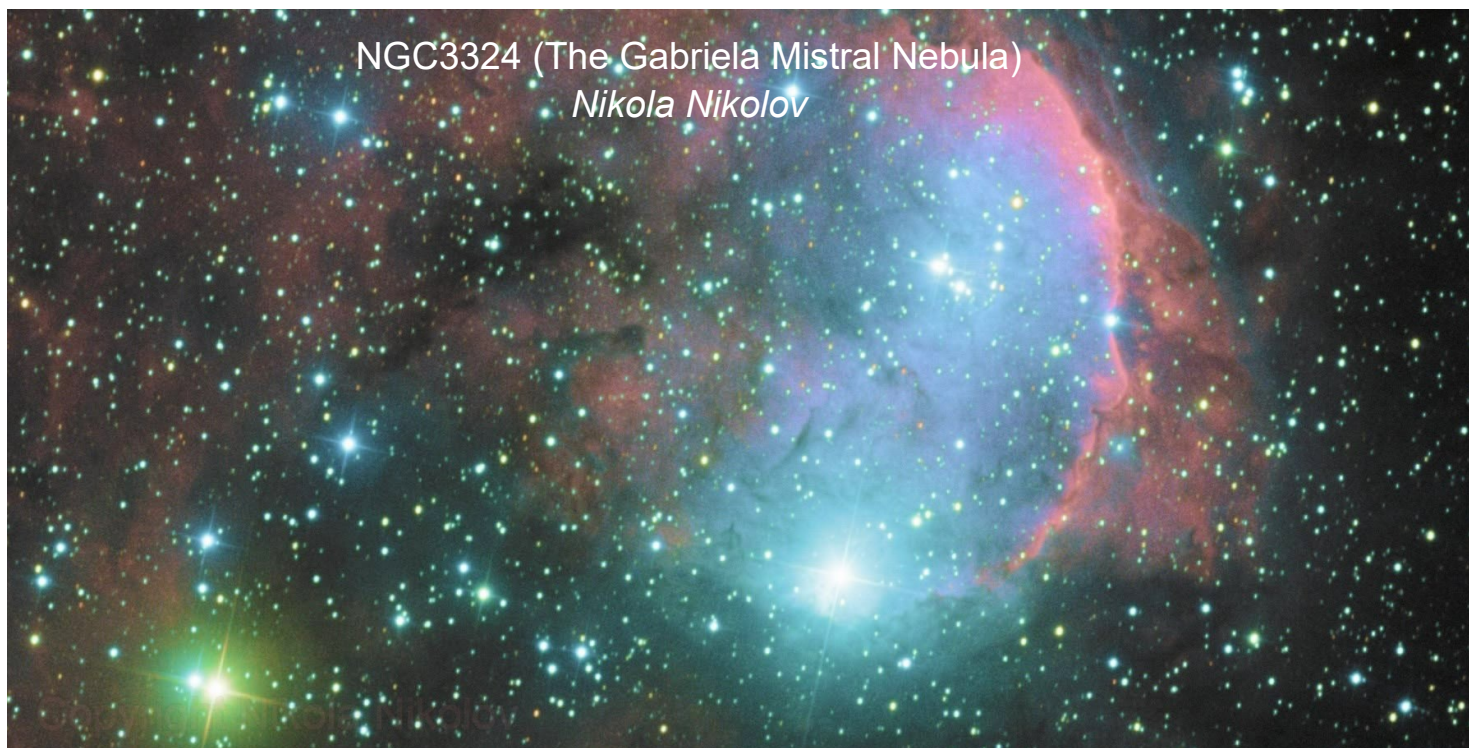
Location: El Sauce Observatory, Río Hurtado, Coquimbo Region, Chile

Imaging Telescope: Planewave CDK24

Imaging Camera: FLI PL 9000

Mount: Mathis MI-1000/1250 with absolute encoders

Software:



Dates: Feb. 12, 2022

Location: Siding Springs observatory, Coonabarabran, New South Wales, Australia

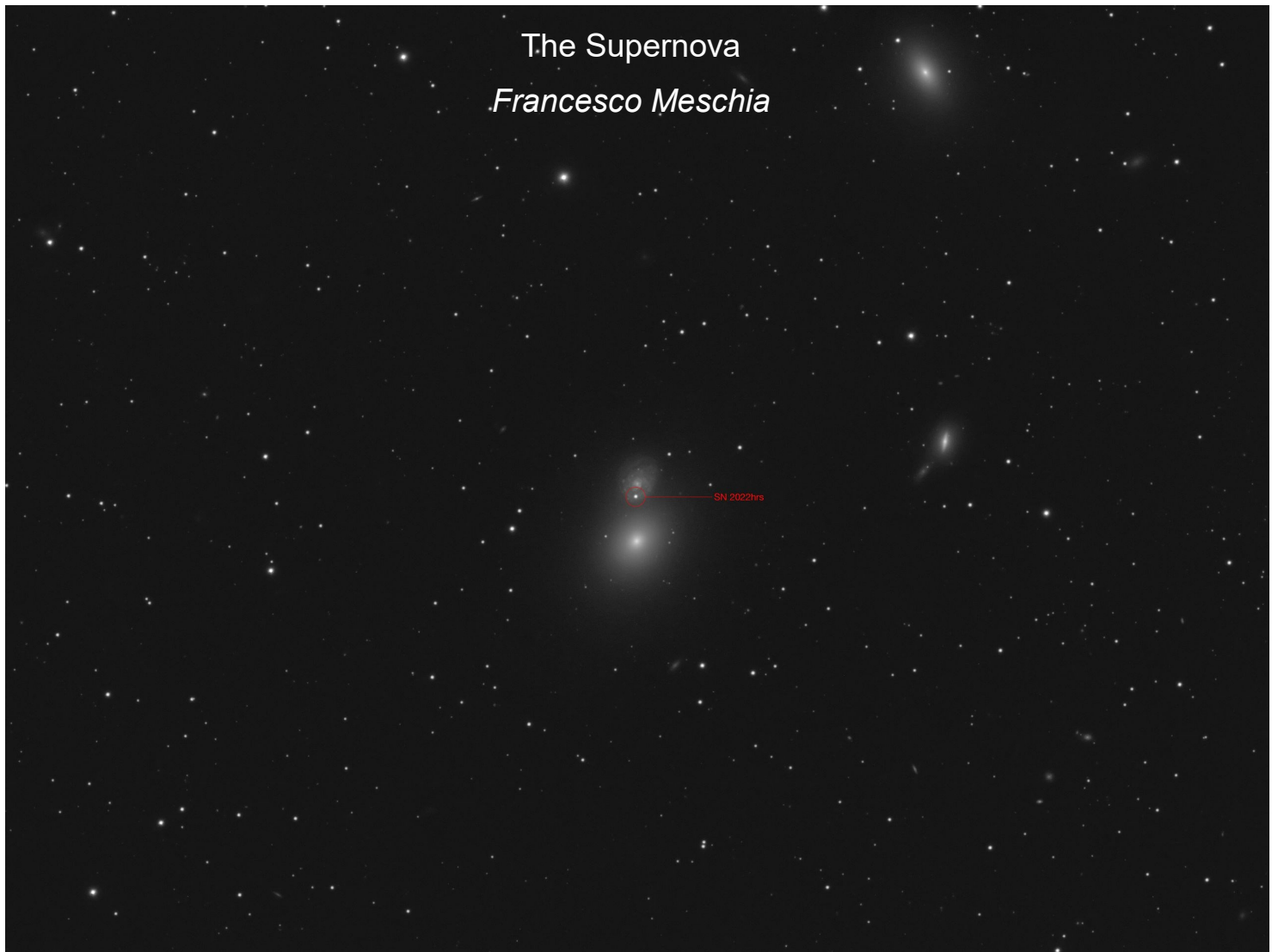
Telescope: Planewave 20" (0.51m) CDK

Camera: FLI-PL09000 CCD

Mount: Planewave Ascension 200HR

Software: StarTools 1.7 Star Tools, AstroPixelProcessor

SJAA Member Astrophoto Gallery



Dates: 24 April 2022

Location: Mountain View CA

Telescope: Astro-Tech AT130EDT

Camera: ZWO ASI294MM-Pro

Mount: iOptron iEQ45 Pro .

Software: N.I.N.A. Nighttime Imaging 'N' Astronomy, Photoshop 2020, Pleiades Astrophoto PixInsight 1.8 Ripely

SJAA Member Astrophoto Gallery



Dates: May 4, 2022

Location: San Jose, CA

Telescope: Celestron. EdgeHD 800

Camera: ZWO ASI2600McPro

Mount: iOptron GEM45

Software: Adobe Photoshop CC Photoshop 2022 · Pleiades Astrophotos PixInsight 1.8.9

Pinnacles Star Party a Success!

Credit: Marianne Damon

The Pinnacles National Park is seeking designation as a Dark Sky Site. They have partnered with SJAA in the past for star parties, and Ed Wong has been the organizer on our side. To celebrate Dark Sky Week, the rangers asked if we would once again host a star party, and Vini offered to head up the team.

The night of April 23rd, the campground was fully booked. Ranger Valerie zipped around the campsites at dinnertime and alerted the campers and late-staying day-hikers about the program. At 8 pm Andy Kreyche from the International Dark-Sky Association gave a talk about the importance of dark skies and what individuals can do to help. He also talked about what was up in our sky that night, about the Lyrid meteor shower, and about the early morning planets. He provided red cello for flashlights, and covered the bathroom lights with it, too. Of note, Andy gave a talk about the IDA to us a Houge Park back in 2017!

After Andy's talk, they all walked over to the lot where we had set up our scopes. Rangers Valerie and Rich supervised. There were seven stations: Rich Gregor, Vini, Natti, Ed, Bob, Wolf and myself. We were happily busy! The attendance was robust, much better than I had anticipated. Public viewing went on until about 10:30. That's when I packed up my little red wagon and went back over to our reserved group campsite. A few stayed on to further enjoy the night sky (the sky was clear but seeing wasn't great --but adequate for the public-- in the beginning, but it did improve over time). I didn't see any Lyrids, but some campers did and were delighted. Almost everyone exclaimed how excited and grateful they were that we were there.

Some comments:

"This is my first time ever camping. I can't believe that I got to experience looking through telescopes, too! This is an experience of a lifetime!"

"I love space. I like to study everything about space. When I get out of college, I'm going to go to space." Told to me by a very eager 7-8 year-old girl.

"I love hearing all the stories about the stars. I didn't know they were connected by stories."

We astronomers guesstimated that we had about 80 viewers. However, Ranger Rich, who was on the periphery the entire time, said: "As for crowd count, my gut says at least 100 and I am not against going as high as 200 given the folks showing up at the end when it was dark. For reference there were at least 50 at the beginning of the talk."

Thanks to Vini for gathering us all together and hosting our very successful Pinnacles Star Party! If/when there is a call for future participation and you enjoy camping and you are experienced at doing public star parties, consider joining in! In return, we get free admittance, a group campsite, and lots of appreciation!





Kid Spot Jokes:

- ♦ **Why did Mickey Mouse go to outer space?**
To find Pluto.
- ♦ **Why didn't the sun go to college?**
Because it already had a million degrees!
- ♦ **What did the doctor say to the rocketship?**
Time to get your booster shot!

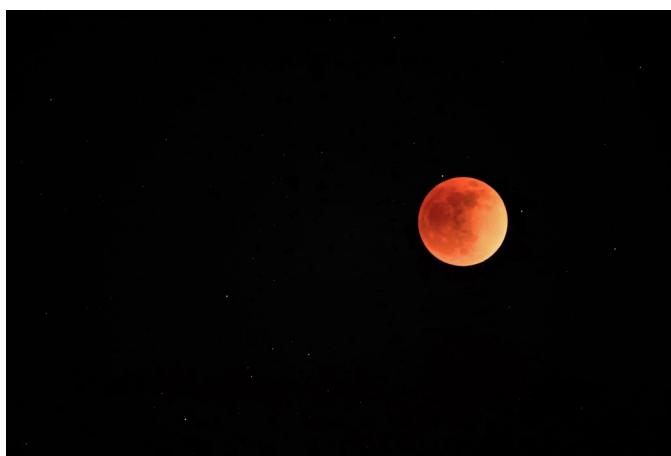
How much do you know about a lunar eclipse

Credit: NASA



11" RASA, 20 stacked, unguided, QHY268, HR 5762 is the star @ the 11 O'clock position.

Credit: PJ Mahany, May 15, 2022



Moon transitioning through totality.

Credit: Ray Illa, May 15, 2022 San Jose, CA

A lunar eclipse occurs when the Sun, Earth, and Moon align so that the Moon passes into Earth's shadow. In a total lunar eclipse, the entire Moon falls within the darkest part of Earth's shadow, called the umbra. When the Moon is within the umbra, it will turn a reddish hue. Lunar eclipses are sometimes called "**Blood Moons**" because of this phenomenon.

The same phenomenon that makes our sky blue and our sunsets red causes the Moon to turn red during a lunar eclipse. It's called **Rayleigh scattering**.

Light travels in waves, and different colors of light have different physical properties.

When the Sun is overhead, we see blue light throughout the sky. But when the Sun is setting, sunlight must pass through more atmosphere and travel farther before reaching our eyes. The blue light from the Sun scatters away, and longer-wavelength red, orange, and yellow light pass through. During a lunar eclipse, the Moon turns red because the only sunlight reaching the Moon passes through Earth's atmosphere. The more dust or clouds in Earth's atmosphere during the eclipse, the redder the Moon will appear. It's as if all the world's sunrises and sunsets are projected onto the Moon!!

You don't need any special equipment to observe a lunar eclipse, although binoculars or a telescope will enhance the view and the red color. A dark environment away from bright lights makes for the best viewing conditions. The adjacent pictures show the last observed blood moon on May 15-16 2022. Also, keep an eye out for the next and last lunar eclipse of the year, that will take place on Nov. 8, 2022.

From the Board of Directors

Announcements

- ◇ San Jose Astronomical Association is closely monitoring the coronavirus/COVID-19 situation in Santa Clara County. In accordance with guidance from Santa Clara County Health Department, SJAA leaders have been canceling many events, especially those that involve close contact and shared surfaces on telescopes. Some events, however, have successfully been moved to an online format.
- ◇ Please check our Meetup to determine if an event has been canceled or moved online. The board of directors will periodically review the status of the outbreak and the guidance from the county to determine the impact upon upcoming events.
- ◇ Officer elections for President, Vice President, Treasurer, and Secretary were held during the March board meeting. Rob Jaworski was reelected as Treasurer. Ken Miura was reelected as President. Aaron Nair was elected as Vice-President and appointed to the vacant position of Secretary. Their terms are effective until March 2023.
- ◇ QuickStart is now taking signups from members. In general will operate around ITSP in very small groups outside.
- ◇

Board Meeting Excerpts

March 19, 2022

In attendance

Swami, Glenn, Ken, Peter Wolf, Sukhada, Rob J, Vini, Steven, Aroon
Absences: none
Guests: Joe, Rich, Jon, Leslie

Officer Elections

Officer elections for President, Vice-President, Treasurer, and Secretary were held during the March board meeting. Ken Miura was reelected as President. Rob Jaworski was reelected as Treasurer. Aroon Nair was elected as Secretary and Vice-President. For a brief bio of Aroon please see page 2 of this edition.

Updated Covid-19 Criteria for SJAA Events

Steven moved that the SJAA policy on Covid-19 protocols at events starting March 22, 2022 be limited to fewer than 1000 people, that SJAA provide sanitizing wipes, disposable masks at events. The motion was approved.

April 9, 2022

In attendance

Swami, Vini, Sukhada, Rob J, Vini, Rob J, Steven, Wolf, Aroon
Absences: Peter, Glenn, Ken
Guests: Kanch, Emi, Nikola

ITSP and Loaner funds approval

Kanch requested the board to pre-approve \$1000 each for ITSP and Loaner programs, to be used towards purchase of essential equipment. Steven moved to accept this request. The motion was seconded by Rob and was passed with 1 person abstained.

Restarting in-person meetings at Houge Park

Swami raised the question of starting in-person meetings and enabling internet access at the Houge Park site. Steven moved the decision to start in-person meetings after internet is made available at Houge Park. The motion was seconded by Sukhada. In favor - 5 abstain - 1. Board to discuss with Satish to set up internet access at the site.

May 21, 2022

In attendance

Wolf, Ken, Sukhada Peter, Steven, Rob J, Aroon
Absences: Glenn, Vini, Swami
Guests: Emi, Jordan,

◇

SJAA Compliance Calendar

Steven moved to approve the SJAA compliance calendar for 2022, and was seconded by Peter. The vote was unanimous to approve.

Principal Office address

Steven moved that 3949 Twilight Dr, San Jose, CA 95124 (Houge Park) be made the principal address for SJAA. Rob seconded the motion. The motion was approved unanimously.

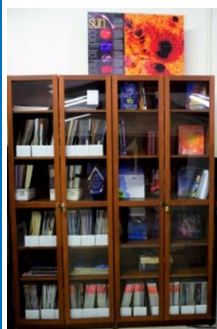
Funds for Solar Program

Wolf moved to authorize up to \$2600 for the solar program, for two imaging cameras, 3 power stations with laptops and monitors, replacement for batteries and power adaptors, and roll-up (camping) tables. Steven seconded the motion. The motion was approved unanimously.

Mask mandates

As per the renewed mask mandate, a mask is required for city of SJ employees, and any volunteers who are indoors (until June 10). The mask mandate will be extended as a SJAA club mandate to anybody who is indoors during an event, and any speakers can choose to not wear a mask while speaking.

SJAA Library



SJAA offers another wonderful resource; a library with good astronomy books and DVDs available to all of our members that will interest all age groups and especially young children who are budding astronomers! You may still send all your questions/comments

to librarian@sjaa.net.

Telescope Fix It Session

Fix It Day, sometimes called the Telescope Tune Up or the Telescope Fix It program is a real simple service the SJAA offers to members of the community for free, though it's priceless. Headed up by Vini Carter, the Fix It session provides a place for people to come with their telescope or other astronomy gear problems and have them looked at, such as broken scopes whose owners need advice, or need help with collimating a telescope.

<http://www.sjaa.net/programs/fixit/>

Solar Observing

Solar observing sessions, headed up by Wolf Witt, are usually held the 1st Sunday of every Month from 2pm - 4pm at Houge Park weather permitting. Please check SJ Astronomy Meetup for schedule details as the event time / location is subject to change.

<http://www.meetup.com/SJ-Astronomy/>

Quick START Program

The Quick START Program, headed up by Steven Nelson, helps to ease folks into amateur astronomy. You have to admit, astronomy can look exciting from the outside, but once you scratch the surface, it can get seemingly complex in a hurry. But it doesn't have to be that way if there's someone to guide you and answer all your seemingly basic questions.

The Quick START program is now taking signups from members. In general will operate around ITSP in very small groups outside.

<http://www.sjaa.net/programs/quick-start/>

Intro to the Night Sky

The Intro to the Night Sky session takes place monthly, in conjunction with first quarter moon and In Town Star Parties at Houge Park. This is a regular, monthly session, run by David Grover, each with a similar format, with only the content changing to reflect what's currently in the night sky. After the session, the attendees will

go outside for a guided, green laser tour of the sky, along with views through SJAA Telescopes at the In-Town Star Party, to get a better look at the night's celestial objects.

<http://www.sjaa.net/programs/beginners-astronomy/>

Loaner Program

Muditha Kanchana (Kanch) heads up this program. The Program goal is for SJAA members to be able to evaluate equipment they are considering purchasing or are just curious about by checking out loaners from SJAA's growing list of equipment. Please note that certain items have restrictions or special conditions that must be met. If you are an SJAA member and an experienced observer or have been through the SJAA Quick START program please fill this form to request a particular item. Please also consider donating unused equipment.

<http://www.sjaa.net/programs/loaner-telescope-program/>

Astro Imaging Special Interest Group (SIG)

SIG has a mission of bringing together people who have an interest in astronomy imaging, or put more simply, taking pictures of the night sky. Run by Hy Murveit the Imaging SIG meets roughly every month at Houge Park to discuss topics about imaging. The SIG is open to people with absolutely no experience but want to learn what it's all about, but experienced imagers are also more than welcome, indeed, encouraged to participate. The best way to get involved is to review the postings on the SJAA Astro Imaging mail list in Google Groups.

<http://www.sjaa.net/programs/imaging-sig/>

Astro Imaging Workshops and Field Clinics

Not to be confused with the SIG group this newly organized program championed by Glenn Newell is a hands on program for club members, who are interested in astro-photography, to have a chance of seeing what it is all about.

Workshops are held at Houge Park once per month and field clinics (members only) once per quarter at a dark sky site. Check the schedule and contact Glenn Newell if you are interested.

School Star Party

The San Jose Astronomical Association conducts evening observing sessions (commonly called "star parties") for schools in mid-Santa Clara County, generally from Sunnyvale to Fremont to Morgan Hill.

Contact SJAA's (Program Coordinator) for additional information.

<http://www.sjaa.net/programs/school-star-party/>

SJAA Contacts

President/Director:	Ken Miura
Vice-President:	Aroon Nair
Treasurer/Dir:	Rob Jaworski
Secretary:	Aroon Nair
Director:	Vini Carter
Director:	Steven Nelson
Director:	Wolf Witt
Director:	Swami Nigam
Director:	Peter Melhus
Director:	Glenn Newell
Director:	Sukhada Palav
Ephemeris Newsletter -	
Content Editor:	Abishek Ramasubramanian
Prod. Editor:	Emi Nikolov
Binocular Stargazing:	Ed Wong
Fix-it Program:	Vini Carter
Hands on Imaging:	Glenn Newell
Imaging SIG:	Hy Murveit
Intro to the Night Sky:	David Grover
In-Town Star Party:	Muditha Kanchana
Library:	Jai Purandare
Loaner Program:	Muditha Kanchana
Memberships:	Kaushal Gangakhedkar
Publicity:	Beth Johnson
Quick START	Steven Nelson
Donations:	Rich Jasper
Solar:	Wolf Witt
Starry Nights:	Joe Fragola
School Events:	Jon Anderson
Refreshments:	Marianne Damon
Social Media Manager:	Beth Johnson
Speakers:	Sukhada Palav
Webmaster:	Satish Vellanki
E-mails:	http://www.sjaa.net/contact

SJAA Ephemeris, the newsletter of the San Jose Astronomical Association, is published quarterly.

Articles, including Observation Reports for publication should be submitted by no later than the 20th of the month of February, May, August and November.

San Jose Astronomical Association
P.O. Box 28243
San Jose, CA 95159-8243
<http://www.sjaa.net/contact>

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Questions? Send e-mail to: memberships@sjaa.net

Bring this form to any SJAA Meeting or send to the address (above). Make checks payable to "SJAA", or join/renew at: <http://www.sjaa.net/join-the-sjaa/>

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